

point of view, about what India needs to do?

We've lost ground. We need to have a little more friendly policies for export. Labour is where we had an issue, which is an inherent long-term issue where we need to have a proper labour policy. Why Bangladesh or Vietnam... look at countries like Ethiopia, the policies that they follow, the industry that they have for export. So, it's just a matter of tweaking it around. We have a plant in Ethiopia for the American market. It's doing very well. America needs products, where will it go? It is getting duty-free and quota-free exports from Ethiopia.

▶▶▶

Obviously, you're very passionate about all your businesses. But if you were to look slightly long term, which businesses are you most



“WE ARE THE ONLY BRAND THAT GOES FROM ₹300 TO ₹10 LAKH A METRE; NOKIA HAD TO DO VERTU—IT’S REBRANDING. RAYMOND IS THE ONLY BRAND THAT, FROM THE TAXI DRIVER TO MR TATA, EVERYBODY HAS IT”

bullish on?

Each one has its own challenges. Lifestyle and real estate are two large growth engines. And engineering-auto has a game plan. So, I'm bullish. Now, one might grow a little less, one might grow a little more, but all four fundamental lines of business

we are in are reasonably doing well. And you're seeing it in the consolidated numbers. The numbers talk for themselves.

▶▶▶

In terms of branding and public perception, despite having business lines in both B2C and

B2B, you're widely perceived as a B2C business. Is that an advantage or a problem?

You'll always be known by your consumer-facing businesses. That's the nature of the beast. That's okay. You don't need to know what my industrial businesses are. It's irrele-

vant to the public at large. Eventually, identity comes from your brand. There's no Gautam Singhania; it's Gautam Singhania of Raymond. Without Raymond, there's no Gautam Singhania, let's be very clear about it. **BT**

@alokeshb